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ReFlection

when I look at my final album cover, the lines, sizes, and values all work together to guide attention and create depth. The jagged diagonal lines of the fortress naturally pull the viewer's eye upward toward the spike, which is the brightest part of the image. The armored figure at the bottom is much smaller, and that size difference makes the fortress feel huge and overwhelming. The darkest values sit around the lower corners and edges, almost framing the scene, which pushes the viewer's focus toward the bright beam of light breaking through the clouds. The towers in the background fade into mist with lighter values and softer edges, which helps create atmospheric perspective and makes the fortress feel even more massive.

The element that stands out the most to me is the glowing crimson symbol carved into the gate. It immediately grabs attention because it's the only warm color in a mostly cold palette. The contrast between the red glow and the surrounding dark values makes it feel like it's pulsing or alive. That unexpected color shift creates emphasis and makes the symbol the first thing your eye jumps to before exploring the rest of the composition.